



ON CLOUD NINE

If you choose the right airline while travelling Business or First Class, flying can be a rewarding experience from the time you enter the airport



ON THE PLATTER

First Class lounges at airports often provide a delectable spread

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After years of flying and 32 flights in the past 24 months or so, I've developed a few strategies to turn the drudgery of international travel into something closer to pleasure. Whether you're a seasoned globetrotter or simply looking to make your next flight a bit more bearable, there are ways to inject a touch of luxury into your journey. Here's how to do it right.

THE RIGHT AIRLINE

Choose the right airline. When it comes to long-haul flights, not all airlines are created equal. I typically fly out of Mumbai, but regardless of where I'm headed, there are only three I actively seek out: Singapore Airlines, Emirates, and Qatar Airways.

Why these three? First, their hubs—Singapore, Dubai, and Doha respectively—aren't just well-connected, they're efficient. These airports are designed to make transits a breeze, with well-organised terminals, minimal waiting times, and lounges that genuinely feel luxurious. And when it comes to service, all three excel. Their cabin crews truly understand hospitality, consistently going above and beyond to transform your experience. Second, the aircraft themselves: you're likely